

To Choose or Not to Choose

Is learning React worth anything anymore?

Priyanka S | feedback@digit.in

As you're reading these words and understanding them, there is probably a new JavaScript framework out already. Should you learn it? Or should you realise that by the time you understand the entirety of it, the framework will become redundant? There truly is a lot to understand when it comes to JavaScript frameworks. Using them is supposed to make the developer's work easier,

web developers agree that skipping the use of a framework will only make your job more difficult. So, like it or not, you will have to choose a framework. Only the best one though, right?

Ultimately, you get to decide what's best for you after considering a framework's pros and cons overall. You can make that decision by getting your hands dirty and testing all these frameworks. Oh, you don't want to? No worries, we'll do the dirty work for you.

EXHIBIT A: REACT

Once you choose this framework, you have to do everything the "React way". React is a framework created by Facebook in 2013. Its main functionality at that point was to build complex UI in an

project extremely easy. All you have to do is type this in your terminal:

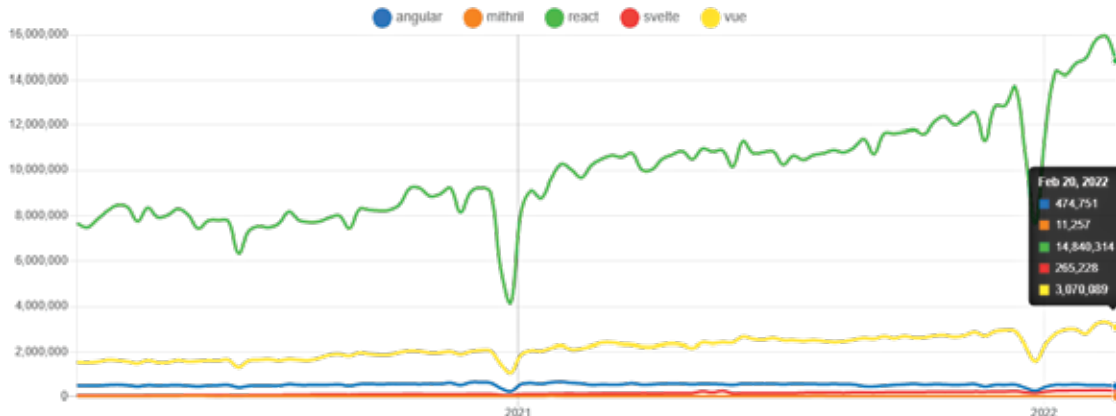
```
npx create-react-app myapp
```

Here, the project name is "myapp".

It will be automatically deployed to your local computer host (generally port 3000). It comes initialised with some basic files. There are many other packages to use with React such as Next.js and Gatsby, which serve completely different purposes. While applying this framework, you will notice that the HTML is a lot more descriptive. The data binding between React components and its respective HTML UI is more clear. However, the code surrounding the life cycle of any React-based application is hard to understand by looking at it. There is a lot of learning that needs to be done, to implement full fledged applications in React.

EXHIBIT B: ANGULAR

It is the first comprehensive front-end framework created for Javascript by Google. Much like React, Angular also requires you to do everything (right from organising your file structure) the



Downloads in the past 2 years.

but choosing one and sticking to it is becoming more difficult as a new framework gains popularity every other day.

From the perspective of industry usage, React seems to be the most popular framework. But Vue has the most stars on GitHub. And Svelte is gaining popularity across devs in 2021, according to a StackOverflow survey. But then you come across an article that condemns the use of frameworks. So, what should a dev do? Which framework is the best? Should a dev use any framework at all? Well, most

efficient manner. React is minimal in its design. After its initial release, the code for React was made open source, and it was left to the community to handle other characteristics such as routing and animation.

While different inputs from experienced developers all around the world has made it extremely flexible, there is a lot of decision fatigue involved while choosing a certain way to create a certain component in your application. React has its own command-line interface (CLI) which makes creating a new

Angular way. It comes with officially-supported libraries for routing, animation and server-side rendering. To implement Angular, you are required to use TypeScript, a syntactical superset to basic JavaScript. Due to its comprehensive nature, it is ideal for big teams to collaborate and build applications on. However, figuring out Angular and TypeScript together would be a huge learning curve for anyone wanting to pursue this framework. When it comes to CLIs, Angular has the most developed one out of all the frameworks.